MSU Main - Bataraza Extension

Mindanao State University Main Campus – Bataraza Extension (MSU-MCBE) is an extension campus of Mindanao State University (MSU) Main Campus in Marawi City. It is located in Bataraza, southern Palawan, and stands as the first MSU campus established outside the island of Mindanao. As part of the MSU System, it operates under the university's broader mandate to deliver quality higher education, promote national integration, and support development across the Mindanao, Sulu, and Palawan (MinSuPala) regions. It functions as a non-autonomous extension of MSU-Main rather than a full constituent university or college. Students are admitted primarily through the MSU System Admission and Scholarship Examination (MSU-SASE), and academic records are managed in coordination with the main campus registrar.

Contents

1 History and Founding
2 Campus and Location
3 Academic Programs
4 Significant Milestones
5 Administration and Governance
6 Contributions and Impact
7 Research Assessment
    7.1 Verified Facts
    7.2 Information Not Yet Verified or Limited
    7.3 Research Gaps

History and Founding

The proposal for an MSU presence in Bataraza gained formal traction in early 2021. The MSU Board of Regents (BOR) approved the establishment of the extension campus on March 22, 2021, following an ocular inspection and evaluation conducted in late February of that year. Local government support, particularly from then-Mayor Abraham Ibba of Bataraza, played a key role in the initiative. A parallel proposal for a campus in nearby Brooke's Point was deferred at the time.

Classes began on October 13, 2021, with an initial enrollment of 147 students. Instruction started in temporary facilities on the second floor of the Bataraza Town Center in Barangay Marangas while permanent infrastructure was prepared. Many early classes were delivered virtually, with faculty support drawn largely from MSU-Marawi.

Groundbreaking for the permanent six-hectare campus in Barangay Inogbong took place on December 6, 2021. The event was attended by MSU System President Dr. Habib W. Macaayong, Palawan Governor Jose C. Alvarez, and Mayor Ibba. An initial three-storey building with 18 classrooms was planned as part of the PGP-MSU-Bataraza School Complex.

Dr. Hernando P. Bacosa, a professor of environmental science at MSU-Iligan Institute of Technology and a native of nearby Brooke's Point, served as the founding Campus Director. He later returned to faculty roles at MSU-IIT. As of recent official listings, Prof. Donnabelle L. Abdullah serves as Director/Campus Head.

Campus and Location

The permanent campus occupies a six-hectare site in Barangay Inogbong, Bataraza, Palawan. Pre-admission and other activities have been held at the Center for Learning and Innovation Building on this site. Earlier operations used the Bataraza Town Center (second floor) in Barangay Marangas as temporary classrooms. Contact details include the email msubataraza@msumain.edu.ph, phone (+63) 968-773-7545, and the Facebook page Mindanao State University Main Campus-Bataraza Extension. A campus website is listed as msubataraza.msumain.edu.ph.

Academic Programs

MSU-MCBE offers undergraduate programs aligned with those of the main campus:

- Bachelor of Science in Nursing
- Bachelor of Science in Civil Engineering
- Bachelor of Secondary Education major in English
- Bachelor of Secondary Education major in Sciences
- Bachelor of Elementary Education major in General Education
- Bachelor of Arts in Islamic Studies major in Shari'ah

Admission is based on MSU-SASE scores, with cut-offs varying by year and program (commonly around 80 or higher for most bachelor's programs in recent cycles, with higher thresholds for scholarships). Some earlier references also mentioned technology-related pathways or Arabic teaching, but the core listed programs above appear consistently in official announcements.

Significant Milestones

In June 2025 the campus held its first pre-commencement exercises at the Mini Coliseum in Bataraza, graduating 59 students from the colleges of Education, Engineering, Health Sciences, and the King Faisal Center for Islamic, Arabic and Asian Studies. Thirty of these graduates earned Latin honors (25 cum laude, 4 magna cum laude, and 1 summa cum laude). Deans and officials from MSU-Main attended to mark the occasion. The first batch of BS Nursing graduates achieved a 100% passing rate (16 out of 16) in the November 2025 Nursing Licensure Examination.

Administration and Governance

MSU-MCBE falls under the administrative oversight of MSU-Main Campus and the MSU System Board of Regents. The System President (currently Atty. Paisalin P. Tago as of mid-2025 listings) holds ultimate authority, with the campus headed by a Director. Faculty and staff recruitment follows system processes, with applications often routed through the campus director and addressed to the System President.

Contributions and Impact

As the first MSU campus outside Mindanao, MSU-MCBE extends the university's long-standing mandate of providing accessible, quality higher education to underserved areas of the MinSuPala region. Local leaders have highlighted its potential to raise educational standards and support economic development in southern Palawan. Its

programs in education, nursing, engineering, and Islamic studies respond to regional needs in teacher training, healthcare, infrastructure, and cultural-religious education. The strong performance of its first nursing cohort has been noted as an early marker of quality.

Research Assessment

Verified Facts

- BOR approval: March 22, 2021.
- Classes started: October 13, 2021 (147 students, temporary site).
- Groundbreaking of permanent 6-hectare campus in Brgy. Inogbong: December 6, 2021.
- First MSU campus outside Mindanao.
- Current programs as listed above.
- First pre-commencement: June 28, 2025 (59 graduates).
- 100% first-time nursing licensure pass rate (November 2025 batch).
- Campus Head: Prof. Donnabelle L. Abdullah (official MSU System listing).
- Founding Campus Director: Dr. Hernando P. Bacosa.

Information Not Yet Verified or Limited

- Detailed independent vision, mission, or core values statements specific to the extension (it inherits the System's).
- Full list of current faculty, exact student enrollment figures beyond the opening year, or complete facilities inventory.
- Formal CHED Certificates of Program Compliance or external accreditation status specific to Bataraza programs (as a young extension, these may still be in process or covered under Main Campus recognition).
- Comprehensive list of student organizations, traditions, or notable alumni (understandable given the campus's short history).
- Precise construction timeline and current status of all permanent buildings beyond the Center for Learning and Innovation Building references.

Research Gaps

Publicly available official documentation remains limited. Most detailed operational information comes from the campus Facebook page, local news reports (especially Palawan News), and MSU System pages. No extensive institutional archive, yearbooks, or peer-reviewed historical studies specifically on MSU-MCBE were located. Future updates from the official campus website, CHED records, or MSU System annual reports would help fill remaining gaps on governance details, research/extension activities, and long-term outcomes.

The campus is still in its early developmental phase. Its rapid progress from approval in 2021 to first graduates and strong licensure results by 2025 demonstrates institutional commitment and local support. Continued monitoring of official MSU and CHED sources will provide the most reliable updates.

Editorial Notice: BangsamoroPedia is a curated knowledge archive. Its pages are maintained by the editorial administrator to help ensure historical accuracy. If you would like to suggest corrections, share sources, or

contribute information, please message the administrator through the official Facebook page: **Notable Muslim Filipinos**.

Retrieved from "http://bangsamoropedia.local/index.php?title=MSU_Main_-_Bataraza_Extension&oldid=3083"